

Selling AI Agents: \$5K/Month Agency Playbook

Source: Andrew Warner interview w/ Nick Vasillescu (Orgo) — action plan derived from transcript

Core Thesis

Businesses will pay **\$5,000/month** for AI agents built on free/open-source tools (Hermes Agent, OpenClaw) — not because the tech is exclusive, but because **implementation, tailoring, and ongoing management** is the actual product. Most business owners don't know these tools exist or how to wire them together reliably.

1 The Offer

- ☐ Package the offer as **one flat retainer**: \$5,000/month
- ☐ Include "unlimited" tokens, agents, and automations under that price
- ☐ Avoid itemized/complex pricing (tokens, seats, usage tiers) — simplicity closes deals
- ☐ Position value as: *"We solve your problems and manage everything — you don't touch the plumbing."*

Why it works: The underlying tools are free. You're selling expertise, reliability, and time saved — the same reason people pay \$20K for a website instead of building one free on Squarespace.

2 The Tech Stack

Layer	Tool	Purpose
Agent harness	Hermes Agent	Most reliable/fastest-growing agent framework; replaced OpenClaw for reliability
Model	OpenClaw	Underlying model layer
Computer use	Orgo	Gives agents their own cloud desktop computers to click/type/operate like a human

Layer	Tool	Purpose
Email	Agent Mail	Spins up a dedicated inbox/API for each agent (remove the "sent with Agent Mail" footer)
Messaging	Agent Phone	Gives agents iMessage capability — no local software needed; one number supports ~6,000 conversations
Payments (early-stage)	Agent Card / Mercury	Agent Card is immature; a Mercury or Ramp card with a tight limit is the simpler near-term solution
Short-term memory	Honcho.dev	Discrete fact recall (e.g., "customer's birthday is X")
Long-term knowledge base	Obsidian	Project-based, interconnected notes (customer names, computer IDs, use cases) — markdown + hyperlinks are agent-friendly
Team interface	Slack	Best for company-wide agent access
Personal interface	Telegram / iMessage	Best for 1:1 "executive assistant" style agents; iMessage wins on simplicity/charm
Tool connections	Composio	Single connector to manage auth/permissions across all business tools (replaces manual API key wrangling)
Content research	VidIQ MCP	Analyze top-performing videos/thumbnails for marketing tasks

Action Steps

- ☐ Set up an Orgo workspace and use **templates** to spin up a cloud computer with Hermes pre-installed (~10–20 sec)
- ☐ Give every agent its own email (Agent Mail) and iMessage number (Agent Phone)
- ☐ Add Honcho for short-term memory + Obsidian for long-term project knowledge
- ☐ Connect business tools via Composio instead of manual API integration

3 Finding First Customers

- ☐ **Start with your phone's contact list** — go through it and flag business owners or decision-makers
- ☐ Reach out with: *"Do you know someone who could benefit from [X]?"* (not "Would you benefit from X?")
- ☐ Offer 2–3 **free case studies** to first clients in exchange for real use cases

- ☐ Ask every prospect: **"What's your first itch?"** — i.e., what repetitive, boring task are you doing daily that doesn't grow the business but eats your time?
- ☐ Prioritize by: **lowest effort/cost + highest value** → build that first
- ☐ Deliver the first solved automation within **7 days**

Result benchmark from transcript: 50 contacts → 7 booked calls in one day → \$3,500 in week one.

4 Marketing / Content

- ☐ Pick **one platform** (Twitter/X in this case) and post under your real name
 - ☐ Show your agents *doing things* — screen recordings of agents onboarding themselves, building automations, using computer-use tools
 - ☐ Let the "meta" moments do the selling (e.g., an agent building another agent)
 - ☐ Avoid cold outbound unless you have no warm network or aren't camera-comfortable — **sales runs on trust**, and content builds trust before the call even happens
-

5 Fulfillment Speed

- ☐ **First agent live within 24 hours** of signing a client
 - ☐ **First automation solved within 7 days**
 - ☐ Prioritize clients with existing **SOPs** — documented processes are the easiest to automate first
 - ☐ Use Orgo templates to eliminate setup friction (pre-installed Hermes, instant cloud desktop)
 - ☐ Meet the client where they already are (Slack, Telegram, iMessage) — don't force a new tool on them
-

6 Customer Retention

- ☐ Schedule a **weekly 1:1 call** with every client
- ☐ Bring **quantitative proof** each week:
 - Before: how long the task used to take
 - After: how long it takes now
 - Direct callback to what the client said their pain point was

- ☐ Keep introducing **new "wow" features** to justify ongoing spend:
 - New model upgrades (e.g., swap in newest model when available)
 - Add Obsidian dashboards (clients often already use Obsidian personally — leverage that familiarity)
 - Harden security / manage secrets via Composio
 - ☐ Remember: businesses stay with people they **like and trust**, not just tools that work
-

Quick-Start Checklist (First 30 Days)

- ☐ Set up Orgo account + Hermes template
 - ☐ Add Agent Mail + Agent Phone to one test agent
 - ☐ Connect Composio for tool access
 - ☐ Build a simple Obsidian vault structure (client name → computer ID → use case)
 - ☐ Go through phone contacts, identify 10–20 warm leads
 - ☐ Ask each: *"What's your first itch?"*
 - ☐ Deliver first automation within 7 days of first "yes"
 - ☐ Post one piece of content showing the agent in action
 - ☐ Set recurring weekly retention calls with each client
 - ☐ Package pricing as flat \$5K/month, unlimited scope
-

Key Quotes to Remember

- *"What's your first itch?"* — the discovery question that surfaces automatable pain points
- *"Solve it, deliver it in the first seven days"* — speed builds trust fast
- *"Businesses want to work with people they like"* — relationship > tooling